

“God be Merciful to Me a Sinner” – Confessing Sin

Luke 18:10-14 Two men went up into the temple to pray; the one a Pharisee, and the other a publican. The Pharisee stood and prayed thus with himself, God, I thank thee, that I am not as other men *are*, extortioners, unjust, adulterers, or even as this publican. I fast twice in the week, I give tithes of all that I possess. And the publican, standing afar off, would not lift up so much as *his* eyes unto heaven, but smote upon his breast, saying, God be merciful to me a sinner. I tell you, this man went down to his house justified *rather* than the other: for every one that exalteth himself shall be abased; and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted.

God requires.

Leviticus 5:5 And it shall be, when he shall be guilty in one of these things, that he shall Confess that he hath Sinned in that thing:

Hosea 5:15 I will go and return to my place, till they acknowledge their offence, and seek my face: in their Affliction they will seek me early.

God regards.

Job 33:27-28 He looketh upon men, and if any say, I have Sinned, and perverted that which was right, and it profited me not; He will deliver his soul from going into the pit, and his life shall see the Light.

Exhortation to.

Joshua 7:19 And Joshua said unto Achan, My son, give, I pray thee, glory to the LORD God of Israel, and make Confession unto him; and tell me now what thou hast done; hide it not from me.

Jeremiah 3:13 Only acknowledge thine iniquity, that thou hast transgressed against the LORD thy God, and hast scattered thy ways to the strangers under every green tree, and ye have not obeyed my voice, saith the LORD.

James 5:16 Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed. The effectual fervent prayer of a Righteous man availeth much.

Promises to.

Leviticus 26:40-42 If they shall Confess their iniquity, and the iniquity of their Fathers, with their trespass which they trespassed against me, and that also they have walked contrary unto me; And that I also have walked contrary unto them, and have brought them into the land of their enemies; if then their uncircumcised hearts be humbled, and they then accept of the punishment of their iniquity: Then will I remember my covenant with Jacob, and also my covenant with Isaac, and also my covenant with Abraham will I remember; and I will remember the land.

Proverbs 28:13 He that covereth his Sins shall not prosper: but whoso Confesseth and forsaketh them shall have mercy.

SHOULD BE ACCOMPANIED WITH

Submission to punishment.

Leviticus 26:41 And that I also have walked contrary unto them, and have brought them into the land of their enemies; if then their uncircumcised hearts be humbled, and they then accept of the punishment of their iniquity:

Nehemiah 9:33 Howbeit thou Art just in all that is brought upon us; for thou hast done right, but we have done wickedly:

Ezra 9:13 And after all that is come upon us for our evil deeds, and for our great trespass, seeing that thou our God hast Punished us less than our iniquities deserve, and hast given us such deliverance as this;

Prayer for forgiveness.

2 Samuel 24:10 And David's heart smote him after that he had numbered the people. And David said unto the LORD, I have Sinned greatly in that I have done: and now, I Beseech thee, O LORD, take away the iniquity of thy Servant; for I have done very foolishly.

Psalms 25:11 For thy name's sake, O LORD, pardon mine iniquity; for it is great.

Psalms 51:1 Have mercy upon me, O God, according to thy lovingkindness: according unto the multitude of thy tender mercies blot out my transgressions.

Jeremiah 14:7-9 O LORD, though our iniquities testify against us, do thou it for thy name's

sake: for our backslidings are many; we have Sinned against thee. O the hope of Israel, the saviour thereof in time of trouble, why shouldest thou be as a stranger in the land, and as a wayfaring man that

turneth aside to tarry for a night? Why shouldest thou be as a man Astonied, as a mighty man that cannot save? yet thou, O LORD, Art in the midst of us, and we are called by thy name; leave us not.

Jeremiah 14:20 We acknowledge, O LORD, our wickedness, and the iniquity of our Fathers: for we have Sinned against thee.

Self-Abasement.

Isaiah 64:5-6 Thou meetest him that rejoiceth and worketh righteousness, those that remember thee in thy ways: behold, thou Art wroth; for we have Sinned: in those is continuance, and we shall be saved. But we are all as an unclean thing, and all our righteousnesses are as filthy rags; and we all do fade as a leaf; and our iniquities, like the wind, have taken us away.

Godly sorrow.

Psalms 38:18 For I will declare mine iniquity; I will be sorry for my Sin.

Lamentations 1:20 Behold, O LORD; for I am in distress: my Bowels are troubled; mine heart is turned within me; for I have grievously rebelled: abroad the sword bereaveth, at home there is as Death.

Forsaking Sin.

Proverbs 28:13 He that covereth his Sins shall not prosper: but whoso Confesseth and forsaketh them shall have mercy.

Restitution.

Numbers 5:6-7 Speak unto the children of Israel, When a man or woman shall commit any Sin that men commit, to do a trespass against the LORD, and that person be guilty; Then they shall Confess their Sin which they have done: and he shall recompense his trespass with the principal thereof, and add unto it the fifth part thereof, and give it unto him against whom he hath trespassed.

Should be full and unreserved.

Psalms 32:5 I acknowledged my Sin unto thee, and mine iniquity have I not hid. I said, I will Confess my transgressions unto the LORD; and thou forgavest the iniquity of my Sin. Selah.

Psalms 51:3 For I acknowledge my transgressions: and my Sin is ever before me.

Psalms 106:6 We have sinned with our fathers, we have committed iniquity, we have done wickedly.

Followed by pardon.

Psalms 32:5 I acknowledged my Sin unto thee, and mine iniquity have I not hid. I said, I will Confess my transgressions unto the LORD; and thou forgavest the iniquity of my Sin. Selah.

1 John 1:9 If we Confess our Sins, he is Faithful and just to forgive us our Sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

Illustrated.

Luke 15:21 And the son said unto him, Father, I have sinned against heaven, and in thy sight, and am no more worthy to be called thy son.

Luke 18:13 And the publican, standing afar off, would not lift up so much as *his* eyes unto heaven, but smote upon his breast, saying, God be merciful to me a sinner.

Exemplified.

Aaron,

Numbers 12:11 And Aaron said unto Moses, Alas, my lord, I Beseech thee, lay not the Sin upon

us, wherein we have done foolishly, and wherein we have Sinned.

Israelites,

Numbers 21:6-7 And the LORD sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people; and much people of Israel died. Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, We have Sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD, and against thee; pray unto the LORD, that he take away the serpents from us. And Moses prayed for the people.

1 Samuel 7:6 And they gathered together to Mizpeh, and drew water, and poured it out before the LORD, and fasted on that day, and said there, We have Sinned against the LORD. And Samuel judged the children of Israel in Mizpeh.

1 Samuel 12:19 And all the people said unto Samuel, Pray for thy servants unto the LORD thy God, that we die not: for we have added unto all our Sins this evil, to ask us a king.

Saul,

1 Samuel 15:24 And Saul said unto Samuel, I have Sinned: for I have transgressed the commandment of the LORD, and thy words: because I feared the people, and obeyed their voice.

David,

2 Samuel 24:10 And David's heart smote him after that he had numbered the people. And David said unto the LORD, I have Sinned greatly in that I have done: and now, I Beseech thee, O LORD, take away the iniquity of thy Servant; for I have done very foolishly.

Ezra,

Ezra 9:6 And said, O my God, I am ashamed and blush to lift up my face to thee, my God: for our iniquities are increased over our head, and our trespass is grown up unto the heavens.

Nehemiah,

Nehemiah 1:6-7 Let thine ear now be attentive, and thine eyes open, that thou mayest hear the prayer of thy Servant, which I pray before thee now, day and night, for the children of Israel thy servants, and Confess the Sins of the children of Israel, which we have Sinned against

thee: both I and my Father's house have Sinned. We have dealt very corruptly against thee, and have not kept the commandments, nor the statutes, nor the judgments, which thou commandedst thy Servant Moses.

Levites,

Nehemiah 9:4 Then stood up upon the stairs, of the Levites, Jeshua, and Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani, and cried with a loud voice unto the LORD their God.

Nehemiah 9:33-34 Howbeit thou Art just in all that is brought upon us; for thou hast done right, but we have done wickedly: Neither have our kings, our Princes, our priests, nor our Fathers, kept thy law, nor hearkened unto thy commandments and thy testimonies, wherewith thou didst testify against them.

Job,

Job 7:20 I have Sinned; what shall I do unto thee, O thou preserver of men? why hast thou set me as a mark against thee, so that I am a burden to myself?

Daniel,

Daniel 9:4 And I prayed unto the LORD my God, and made my Confession, and said, O Lord, the great and dreadful God, keeping the covenant and mercy to them that love him, and to them that keep his commandments;

Peter,

Luke 5:8 When Simon Peter saw it, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, Depart from me; for I am a sinful man, O Lord.

Thief,

Luke 23:41 And we indeed justly; for we receive the due reward of our deeds: but this man hath done nothing Amiss.